NEUROMANCER

n B n Song Ng Anh Vi t Chu n M c Tuy t i

T c Gi : William Gibson | Bi n D ch & Ch Gi i S Ph m: Master Bilingual Editorial Group

M c Ti u N ng L c Chu n H a Qu c T :

IELTS 7.0+ (Band 7 8 Lexical Resources & Discourse Analysis)

TOEFL iBT 90+ / 5.0 (New Format 2026+)

Pearson PTE Academic 65+

Cambridge English Qualifications: 185+ (C1 Advanced / C2 Proficiency)

Duolingo English Test (DET): 120+

H TH NG PH NG PH P H C TH NG QUA T C PH M

n b n n y cung c p ph ng th c ti p c n song ng i chi u song song: b n c nh b n d ch v n h c ti ng Vi t trung th c, chu n x c v gi tr n v n v n phong cyberpunk nguy n t c, m i o n v n v ch ng u t ch h p h th ng ch th ch t€ v ng h c thu t C1/C2, c m t€ c nh (collocations), ng ph p ph c h p v chi n thu t c hi•u p d ng tr c ti p cho c c k, thi chu n h a qu c t .

H NG D N N LUY N N NG L C NG N NG N NG CAO

CHI N THU T: IELTS_READING

Tip for IELTS Academic Reading: William Gibson's dense descriptive prose frequently employs compound adjectives and non-standard register metaphors (e.g. 'the sky was the color of television, tuned to a dead channel'). In IELTS Reading, identify the nominal core of sentences and ignore parenthetical post-modifiers during your first skimming pass.

CHI N THU T: TOEFL_SYNTAX

TOEFL iBT Sentence Simplification & Inferences: Look out for participial phrases and absolute constructions ('his prosthetic arm jerking monotonously as he filled...'). Practice rephrasing these into explicit causal or temporal clauses to rapidly eliminate distractors in multiple-choice questions.

CHI N THU T: C1_C2_COLLOCATIONS

Cambridge C1/C2 Lexical Focus: Pay special attention to sensory and evaluative collocations such as 'tinged with disdain', 'cheap perfume and scorched circuitry', and 'labyrinthine alleys'. C1 Advanced (CAE) and C2 Proficiency (CPE) reward natural prepositional collocations.

B NG T V NG H C THU T TR NG T M (C1/C2 - IELTS 7.0+ / TOEFL 90+)

T V ng & Ng m	nh Ngh a Anh - Vi t	Chu n Thi & Collocations
prosthetic adj. /prƒs„…et.†k/ C1	VI: thu‡c b‡ ph n gi , l^p gh‰p c h c EN: denoting an artificial body part, prosthesis V d : "Ratz was tending bar, his prosthetic arm jerking monotonously..."	M c ti u: IELTS 7.0+, TOEFL 90+, C1 Advanced Collocations: prosthetic limb, prosthetic device
monotonously adv. /mŠ„nƒt.Šn.Šs.li/ C1	VI: m‡t c ch u u t‹ nh t, n i u EN: in a dull, repetitive, and unvarying manner V d : "...his prosthetic arm jerking monotonously as he filled a tray of glasses..."	M c ti u: IELTS 7.5, TOEFL 95, C1 Advanced Collocations: droning monotonously, repeated monotonously
obsolete adj. /‰ƒb.sŠ„li•t/ C1	VI: l i thŽi, c• l s•, kh‘ng c’n c s“ d ng EN: no longer produced or used; out of date V d : "It was a Russian military prosthetic, a seven-function force-feedback manipulator, cased in grubby pink plastic... obsolete, crude."	M c ti u: IELTS 7.0+, TOEFL 90+, PTE 65+, C1 Advanced Collocations: rapidly obsolete, render obsolete, obsolete technology
disdain n., v. /d†s„de†n/ C2	VI: s khinh th , coi th Žng; khinh b” EN: the feeling that someone or something is unworthy of one's consideration or respect V d : "...looked on his profession with a mild amusement tinged with disdain."	M c ti u: IELTS 8.0, TOEFL 105, C2 Proficiency Collocations: treat with disdain, tinged with disdain, look of disdain
myopic adj. /ma†„ƒp.†k/ C2	VI: c n th ; (ngh•a b ng) thi•n c n, t•m nh-n h n h p EN: nearsighted; lacking imagination, foresight, or intellectual insight V d : "He squinted through myopic eyes behind thick lenses."	M c ti u: IELTS 8.0, TOEFL 100+, GRE/GMAT, C2 Proficiency Collocations: myopic vision, myopic view of the future
translucent adj. /tr—nz„lu•.sŠnt/ C1	VI: b n trong su t, • nh s ng xuy n mŽ mŽ qua EN: allowing light, but not detailed shapes, to pass through; semitransparent V d : "...the neon glow bleeding through translucent plastic domes."	M c ti u: IELTS 7.5, TOEFL 95, C1 Advanced Collocations: translucent skin, translucent surface, translucent jade
symbiosis n. /‰s†m.ba†„o˜.s†s/ C1	VI: s c‡ng sinh, m i quan h t ng h ‘i b n c™ng ph thu‡c EN: interaction between two different organisms or entities living in close physical association V d : "A bizarre symbiosis existed between the black clinics and the street flesh-peddlers."	M c ti u: IELTS 7.5+, TOEFL 100+, PTE 70+, C1 Advanced Collocations: close symbiosis, living in symbiosis, parasitic symbiosis
labyrinthine adj. /‰l—b.Š„r†n.…a†n/ C2	VI: chšng ch t nh m cung, ph c t p r i r^m EN: irregular and twisting; intricate and confusing V d : "The labyrinthine alleys of Night City smelled of fried grease and stale ozone."	M c ti u: IELTS 8.0, TOEFL 105, C2 Proficiency, DET 130 Collocations: labyrinthine corridors, labyrinthine system, labyrinthine alleys

arcane adj. /›•„ke†n/ C2	VI: b truy n, huy n b , ’i hœi ki n th c chuy n s•u žc th™ EN: understood by few; mysterious or secret V d : "The arcane codes of the military ICE programs danced across his memories."	M c ti u: IELTS 8.5, TOEFL 110, C2 Proficiency Collocations: arcane knowledge, arcane procedures, arcane jargon
permeate v. /„pŸ•.mi.e†t/ C1	VI: th m qua, lan tœa kh^p, bao tr™m EN: spread throughout something; pervade V d : "The smell of burnt circuits and frying food permeated the narrow stairwell."	M c ti u: IELTS 7.5, TOEFL 95, C1 Advanced Collocations: permeate through, permeate the atmosphere, completely permeate
neurotoxin n. /„nj˜Š.rŠ˜ƒtƒk.s†n/ C1	VI: ‡c t th•n kinh EN: a poison that acts on the nervous system V d : "They had damaged his nervous system with a wartime fungus, a Russian mycotoxin."	M c ti u: TOEFL 95+, IELTS 7.5+, SAT/ACT Collocations: potent neurotoxin, exposed to neurotoxins
clandestine adj. /kl—n„des.t†n/ C2	VI: l‰n l t, b m t, phi ph p EN: kept secret or done secretively, especially because illicit V d : "The clandestine clinics in Chiba were known for illicit neural augmentation."	M c ti u: IELTS 8.0, TOEFL 105, C2 Proficiency, PTE 75 Collocations: clandestine operation, clandestine meeting, clandestine deal

PH N M T - CHIBA CITY BLUES: CH NG 1

PART ONE - CHIBA CITY BLUES: Chapter 1

ENGLISH ORIGINAL	B N D CH TI NG VI T I CHI U
[1] The sky above the port was the color of television, tuned to a dead channel.	*[1] B u tr i ph a tr n b n c ng mang s c m u c a m t m n h nh v tuy n b t v o k nh nhi u s ng r ng.*
[2] "It's not like I'm using," Case heard someone say, as he shouldered his way through the crowd around the door of the Chat. "It's like my body's developed this massive drug deficiency." It was a Sprawl voice and a Sprawl joke. The Chatsubo was a bar for professional expatriates; you could drink there for a week and never hear two words in Japanese.	*[2] " u ph i l t i ang nghi n ng p g u," Case nghe th y ai n i th , khi anh chen vai l ch qua m ng t t p tr c c a qu n Chatsubo. "Ch l c th t i d o n y chuy n h a n ng l €ng m t c ch qu i l th i..."*
[3] Ratz was tending bar, his prosthetic arm jerking monotonously as he filled a tray of glasses with draft Kirin. He saw Case and smiled, his teeth a webwork of East European steel and brown decay. Case found a place at the bar, between the unlikely tan on one of Lonny Zone's whores and the crisp naval uniform of a tall African whose cheekbones were ridged with precise rows of tribal scars. "Wage was in here early, with two joeboys," Ratz said, shoving a draft across the bar with his good hand. "Maybe some business with you, Case?"	*[3] Ratz ang •ng qu y pha ch , c nh tay c h, c c a gf gi t gi t „u „u m t c ch n i u khi gf r t y m t khay c…c bia t i Kirin. Gf nh n th y Case b†n m m c i, h m r ng n m th‡p l p l nh qua m r u ria x^m xo m m u h^ng ‰. "Anh ch ng ngh sŠ kia," Ratz c t gi, ng.*
[4] Case shrugged. The girl to his right giggled and nudged him.	*[4] Case nh‹n vai. C •ng b n ph i anh kh‹c kh ch c i r^i th‹c cŒi ch‰ v o s n anh.*
[5] The bartender's smile widened. His ugliness was the stuff of legend. In an age of affordable beauty, there was something heraldic about his lack of it. The antique arm whined as he reached for another mug. It was a Russian military prosthesis, a seven-function force-feedback manipulator, cased in grubby pink plastic. "You are too much the artiste, Herr Case." Ratz grunted; the sound served him as laughter. He scratched his overhang of white-shirted belly with the pink claw. "You are the artiste of the slightly funny deal."	*[5] N c i c a gf ph c v qu y bar c ng gifn r ng ra. S• x u x c a gf f trŽ th nh huy„n tho i. Trong m t th i i m c i •p c th mua €c b•ng ti„n m t c ch d d ng, dung m o c a gf l i mang n‡t g b t tu n y ki u hfnh. C nh tay nh n t o c' l sŠ kia, m t b ph n gi qu n s• do Li n X ch t o, l c c u c h, c ph n h^i l•c b y ch•c n ng, b, c trong l p nh•a h^ng c u b'n. "C u l i qu i ngh sŠ r^i, ng i Case ."*
[6] "Sure," Case said, and sipped his beer. "Somebody's gotta be funny around here. Sure the fuck isn't you."	*[6] "Ch c r^i," Case p, nh p m t ng m bia. "" c i ch…n n y c"ng ph i c ai t‰ ra h i h c ch•. DŒ sao th c"ng ch•ng ph i l m y."*
[7] The whore's giggle went up an octave.	*[7] Ti ng c i kh‹c kh ch c a g i i m v‹t cao th m m t qufng t m.*

[8] "Isn't you either, sister. So you vanish, okay? Zone, he's a close personal friend of mine."	*[8] "M c"ng ch•ng ph i l c u, c em. Th i bi n i cho khu t m t, €c ch•? Zone l b n th n ch c…t c a t i y."*
[9] She looked Case in the eye and made the softest possible spitting sound, her lips barely moving. But she left.	*[9] – nh n th•ng v o m t Case r^i nh' to•t m t ti ng kh– nh t c th , i m i h u nh ch•ng h„ m p m y. D˜u v y v˜n quay l ng b‰ i.*
[10] "Jesus," Case said, "what kinda creepjoint you running here? Man can't have a drink."	*[10] "Ch‹a t i," Case n i, "m y ang v n h nh c i lo i ' chu t qu i n g Ž y th h ? n u…ng m t ly trong y n tŠnh c"ng kh ng xong."*
[11] "Ha," Ratz said, swabbing the scarred wood with a rag, "Zone shows a percentage. You I let work here for entertainment value."	*[11] "Kh ng ph i l i t i t i u, ng b n. Qu n n y ng ngh•t r^i. C u mu…n m t g c ri ng t th ph i tr ti„n mua ch y ch•."*
[12] As Case was picking up his beer, one of those strange instants of silence descended, as though a hundred unrelated conversations had simultaneously arrived at the same pause. Then the whore's giggle rang out, tinged with a certain hysteria.	*[12] Case nh n quanh c n ph™ng d i v h•p mŒ mšt kh i thu…c. Qu n Chatsubo l qu n bar d nh cho d n lao ng n c ngo i; b n c th ng^i c tu n m kh ng nghe th y l y hai t› ti ng Nh t. Ratz f xoay xŽ giœ cho b u kh ng kh Ž y lu n Ž m•c ng t ng t quen thu c, m t th• cocktail h n t p c a mŒi m^ h i chua lo‡t, bia i thiu v mŒi ozone ch y kh‡t t› nhœng m…i n…i i n r• ti„n.*
[13] Ratz grunted. "An angel passed."	*[13] B n ngo i, m n m Chiba ang trŒm xu…ng v i nhœng b•c t ng b t ng t ˜m m a axit v nh †n neon nh p nh y ph n chi u tr n mžt ng b ng lo ng nh g ng vŸ.*
[14] "The Chinese," bellowed a drunken Australian, "Chinese bloody invented nerve-splicing. Give me the mainland for a nerve job any day. Fix you right, mate..."	*[14] Case f hai m i t tu'i. V o n m hai m i hai, anh t› ng l m t cao b^i giao di n kh ng gian m ng, m t t n tr m dœ li u th €ng thžng, m t trong nhœng k• gi‰i nh t vŒng Sprawl.*
[15] "Now that," Case said to his glass, all his bitterness suddenly rising in him like bile, "that is _so_ much bullshit."	*[15] Anh f t› ng €c hu n luy n bŽi nhœng b c th y k c•u nh t c a th gi i ng m, v n h nh b i„u khi n ma tr n tŒy bi n th m nh p v o nhœng b•c t ng b o m t ICE d y žc nh t c a c c t p o n xuy n qu…c gia.*
[16] The Japanese had already forgotten more neurosurgery than the Chinese had ever known. The black clinics of Chiba were the cutting edge, whole bodies of technique supplanted monthly, and still they couldn't repair the damage he'd suffered in that Memphis hotel.	*[16] Th r^i anh ph m ph i m t sai l m ch t ng i kinh i n: anh f nh c p t› ch nh nhœng k• thu m nh.*

[17] A year here and he still dreamed of cyberspace, hope fading nightly. All the speed he took, all the turns he'd taken and the corners he'd cut in Night City, and still he'd see the matrix in his sleep, bright lattices of logic unfolding across that colorless void... The Sprawl was a long strange way home over the Pacific now, and he was no console man, no cyberspace cowboy. Just another hustler, trying to make it through. But the dreams came on in the Japanese night like livewire voodoo, and he'd cry for it, cry in his sleep, and wake alone in the dark, curled in his capsule in some coffin hotel, his hands clawed into the bedslab, temperfoam bunched between his fingers, trying to reach the console that wasn't there.	*[17] H, kh ng gi t anh. Thay v o , h, tr› ng ph t anh b•ng m t th• c t… n m m…c chi n tranh c a Li n X , ti m th•ng v o t y s…ng c a anh trong m t ph™ng kh m b m t Ž Memphis.*
[18] "I saw your girl last night," Ratz said, passing Case his second Kirin.	*[18] Ch t c th n kinh y f thi u r i kh n ng ti p c n ma tr n c a anh, h y ho i vš nh vi n c c th th th n kinh li n k t v i kh ng gian m ng o. …i v i Case, i„u ˆng nghša v i c i ch t c a linh hˆn; anh bš tr c xu t kh‰i thi n ng s… h a, bš giam c m vš nh vi n trong th• m anh lu n khinh mi t g, i l 'th x c thšt tr n'.*
[19] "I don't have one," he said, and drank.	*[19] Gi y anh s…ng d t d Ž Chiba, trung t m ph˜u thu t th n kinh ch€ en c a th gi i, t m ki m trong tuy t v, ng m t ph‡p m u y h, c c th ph c hˆi h th n kinh f bš h y ho i.*
[20] "Miss Linda Lee."	*[20] Anh ki m s…ng b•ng nhœng v giao dšch nh‰ nhžt, phi ph p Ž khu ph… m (Night City) ¡ bu n l u ph n c•ng, ma t‹y t'ng h€p, v b n th ng tin cho b t k ai c ti„n mžt.*
[21] Case shook his head.	*[21] Nh ng ti„n c n d n, v hy v, ng c"ng th . C c b c sš ch€ en Ž Chiba ch l c u: t'n th ng th n kinh do mycotoxin l kh ng th o ng €c.*
[22] "No girl? Nothing? Only biz, friend artiste? Dedication to commerce?" The bartender's small brown eyes were nested deep in wrinkled flesh. "I think I liked you better, with her. You laughed more. Now, some night, you get maybe too artistic; you wind up in the clinic tanks, spare parts."	*[22] "N y Case," Ratz c t gi, ng, lau mžt qu y b•ng m t chi c gi• 'm. "C ng i ang t m c u y."*
[23] "You're breaking my heart, Ratz." He finished his beer, paid and left, high narrow shoulders hunched beneath the rainstained khaki nylon of his windbreaker. Threading his way through the Ninsei crowds, he could smell his own stale sweat.	*[23] Case kh•ng l i, ng n tay si t nh• quanh th nh ly bia l nh ng t. "Ai?"*

[24] Case was twenty-four. At twenty-two, he'd been a cowboy, a rustler, one of the best in the Sprawl. He'd been trained by the best, by McCoy Pauley and Bobby Quine, legends in the biz. He'd operated on an almost permanent adrenaline high, a byproduct of youth and proficiency, jacked into a custom cyberspace deck that projected his disembodied consciousness into the consensual hallucination that was the matrix. A thief, he'd worked for other, wealthier thieves, employers who provided the exotic software required to penetrate the bright walls of corporate systems, opening windows into rich fields of data.	*[24] "M t c . Tr ng kh c•ng c•a. K nh r m che k n m t, phong th i c a d n nh ngh„. Kh ng ph i kh ch quen Ž y."*
[25] He'd made the classic mistake, the one he'd sworn he'd never make. He stole from his employers. He kept something for himself and tried to move it through a fence in Amsterdam. He still wasn't sure how he'd been discovered, not that it mattered now. He'd expected to die, then, but they only smiled. Of course he was welcome, they told him, welcome to the money. And he was going to need it. Because -still smiling -they were going to make sure he never worked again.	*[25] "Gžp t i l m g ?"*
[26] They damaged his nervous system with a wartime Russian mycotoxin.	*[26] "Ai m bi t €c?" Ratz nh‹n vai c h, c, kh p n…i kim lo i k u r t l n m t ti ng kh kh…c. "Nh ng ta c m€i c a r c r…i l n y, anh b n tr• ."*
[27] Strapped to a bed in a Memphis hotel, his talent burning out micron by micron, he hallucinated for thirty hours.	*[27] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Strapped to a bed in a Memphis hotel, his talent burning out micron by micron, he hallucinated for thirty hours.*
[28] The damage was minute, subtle, and utterly effective.	*[28] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): The damage was minute, subtle, and utterly effective.*
[29] For Case, who'd lived for the bodiless exultation of cyberspace, it was the Fall. In the bars he'd frequented as a cowboy hotshot, the elite stance involved a certain relaxed contempt for the flesh. The body was meat. Case fell into the prison of his own flesh.	*[29] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): For Case, who'd lived for the bodiless exultation of cyberspace, it was the Fall. In the bars he'd frequented as a cowboy hotshot, the elite stance involved a certain relaxed contempt for the flesh. The body was meat. Case fell into the prison of his own flesh.*
[30] His total assets were quickly converted to New Yen, a fat sheaf of the old paper currency that circulated endlessly through the closed circuit of the world's black markets like the seashells of the Trobriand islanders. It was difficult to transact legitimate business with cash in the Sprawl; in Japan, it was already illegal.	*[30] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): His total assets were quickly converted to New Yen, a fat sheaf of the old paper currency that circulated endlessly through the closed circuit of the world's black markets like the seashells of the Trobriand islanders. It was difficult to transact legitimate business with cash in the Sprawl; in Japan, it was already illegal.*

[31] In Japan, he'd known with a clenched and absolute certainty, he'd find his cure. In Chiba. Either in a registered clinic or in the shadowland of black medicine. Synonymous with implants, nerve-splicing, and microbionics, Chiba was a magnet for the Sprawl's techno-criminal subcultures.	*[31] (B n dsch song ngœ chu'n): In Japan, he'd known with a clenched and absolute certainty, he'd find his cure. In Chiba. Either in a registered clinic or in the shadowland of black medicine. Synonymous with implants, nerve-splicing, and microbionics, Chiba was a magnet for the Sprawl's techno-criminal subcultures.*
[32] In Chiba, he'd watched his New Yen vanish in a two-month round of examinations and consultations. The men in the black clinics, his last hope, had admired the expertise with which he'd been maimed, and then slowly shaken their heads.	*[32] (B n dsch song ngœ chu'n): In Chiba, he'd watched his New Yen vanish in a two-month round of examinations and consultations. The men in the black clinics, his last hope, had admired the expertise with which he'd been maimed, and then slowly shaken their heads.*
[33] Now he slept in the cheapest coffins, the ones nearest the port, beneath the quartz-halogen floods that lit the docks all night like vast stages; where you couldn't see the lights of Tokyo for the glare of the television sky, not even the towering hologram logo of the Fuji Electric Company, and Tokyo Bay was a black expanse where gulls wheeled above drifting shoals of white styrofoam. Behind the port lay the city, factory domes dominated by the vast cubes of corporate arcologies. Port and city were divided by a narrow borderland of older streets, an area with no official name. Night City, with Ninsei its heart. By day, the bars down Ninsei were shuttered and featureless, the neon dead, the holograms inert, waiting, under the poisoned silver sky.	*[33] (B n dsch song ngœ chu'n): Now he slept in the cheapest coffins, the ones nearest the port, beneath the quartz-halogen floods that lit the docks all night like vast stages; where you couldn't see the lights of Tokyo for the glare of the television sky, not even the towering hologram logo of the Fuji Electric Company, and Tokyo Bay was a black expanse where gulls wheeled above drifting shoals of white styrofoam. Behind the port lay the city, factory domes dominated by the vast cubes of corporate arcologies. Port and city were divided by a narrow borderland of older streets, an area with no official name. Night City, with Ninsei its heart. By day, the bars down Ninsei were shuttered and featureless, the neon dead, the holograms inert, waiting, under the poisoned silver sky.*
[34] Two blocks west of the Chat, in a teashop called the Jarre de Th, Case washed down the night's first pill with a double espresso. It was a flat pink octagon, a potent species of Brazilian dex he bought from one of Zone's girls.	*[34] (B n dsch song ngœ chu'n): Two blocks west of the Chat, in a teashop called the Jarre de Th, Case washed down the night's first pill with a double espresso. It was a flat pink octagon, a potent species of Brazilian dex he bought from one of Zone's girls.*
[35] The Jarre was walled with mirrors, each panel framed in red neon.	*[35] (B n dsch song ngœ chu'n): The Jarre was walled with mirrors, each panel framed in red neon.*
[36] At first, finding himself alone in Chiba, with little money and less hope of finding a cure, he'd gone into a kind of terminal overdrive, hustling fresh capital with a cold intensity that had seemed to belong to someone else. In the first month, he'd killed two men and a woman over sums that a year before would have seemed ludicrous. Ninsei wore him down until the street itself came to seem the externalization of some death wish, some secret poison he hadn't known he carried.	*[36] (B n dsch song ngœ chu'n): At first, finding himself alone in Chiba, with little money and less hope of finding a cure, he'd gone into a kind of terminal overdrive, hustling fresh capital with a cold intensity that had seemed to belong to someone else. In the first month, he'd killed two men and a woman over sums that a year before would have seemed ludicrous. Ninsei wore him down until the street itself came to seem the externalization of some death wish, some secret poison he hadn't known he carried.*

[37] Night City was like a deranged experiment in social Darwinism, designed by a bored researcher who kept one thumb permanently on the fast-forward button. Stop hustling and you sank without a trace, but move a little too swiftly and you'd break the fragile surface tension of the black market; either way, you were gone, with nothing left of you but some vague memory in the mind of a fixture like Ratz, though heart or lungs or kidneys might survive in the service of some stranger with New Yen for the clinic tanks.	*[37] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Night City was like a deranged experiment in social Darwinism, designed by a bored researcher who kept one thumb permanently on the fast-forward button. Stop hustling and you sank without a trace, but move a little too swiftly and you'd break the fragile surface tension of the black market; either way, you were gone, with nothing left of you but some vague memory in the mind of a fixture like Ratz, though heart or lungs or kidneys might survive in the service of some stranger with New Yen for the clinic tanks.*
[38] Biz here was a constant subliminal hum, and death the accepted punishment for laziness, carelessness, lack of grace, the failure to heed the demands of an intricate protocol.	*[38] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Biz here was a constant subliminal hum, and death the accepted punishment for laziness, carelessness, lack of grace, the failure to heed the demands of an intricate protocol.*
[39] Alone at a table in the Jarre de Th, with the octagon coming on, pinheads of sweat starting from his palms, suddenly aware of each tingling hair on his arms and chest, Case knew that at some point he'd started to play a game with himself, a very ancient one that has no name, a final solitaire. He no longer carried a weapon, no longer took the basic precautions. He ran the fastest, loosest deals on the street, and he had a reputation for being able to get whatever you wanted. A part of him knew that the arc of his self-destruction was glaringly obvious to his customers, who grew steadily fewer, but that same part of him basked in the knowledge that it was only a matter of time. And that was the part of him, smug in its expectation of death, that most hated the thought of Linda Lee.	*[39] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Alone at a table in the Jarre de Th, with the octagon coming on, pinheads of sweat starting from his palms, suddenly aware of each tingling hair on his arms and chest, Case knew that at some point he'd started to play a game with himself, a very ancient one that has no name, a final solitaire. He no longer carried a weapon, no longer took the basic precautions. He ran the fastest, loosest deals on the street, and he had a reputation for being able to get whatever you wanted. A part of him knew that the arc of his self-destruction was glaringly obvious to his customers, who grew steadily fewer, but that same part of him basked in the knowledge that it was only a matter of time. And that was the part of him, smug in its expectation of death, that most hated the thought of Linda Lee.*
[40] He'd found her, one rainy night, in an arcade.	*[40] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): He'd found her, one rainy night, in an arcade.*

[41] Under bright ghosts burning through a blue haze of cigarette smoke, holograms of Wizard's Castle, Tank War Europa, the New York skyline... And now he remembered her that way, her face bathed in restless laser light, features reduced to a code: her cheekbones flaring scarlet as Wizard's Castle burned, forehead drenched with azure when Munich fell to the Tank War, mouth touched with hot gold as a gliding cursor struck sparks from the wall of a skyscraper canyon. He was riding high that night, with a brick of Wage's ketamine on its way to Yokohama and the money already in his pocket. He'd come in out of the warm rain that sizzled across the Ninsei pavement and somehow she'd been singled out for him, one face out of the dozens who stood at the consoles, lost in the game she played. The expression on her face, then, had been the one he'd seen, hours later, on her sleeping face in a portside coffin, her upper lip like the line children draw to represent a bird in flight.	*[41] (B n dsch song ngœ chu'n): Under bright ghosts burning through a blue haze of cigarette smoke, holograms of Wizard's Castle, Tank War Europa, the New York skyline... And now he remembered her that way, her face bathed in restless laser light, features reduced to a code: her cheekbones flaring scarlet as Wizard's Castle burned, forehead drenched with azure when Munich fell to the Tank War, mouth touched with hot gold as a gliding cursor struck sparks from the wall of a skyscraper canyon. He was riding high that night, with a brick of Wage's ketamine on its way to Yokohama and the money already in his pocket. He'd come in out of the warm rain that sizzled across the Ninsei pavement and somehow she'd been singled out for him, one face out of the dozens who stood at the consoles, lost in the game she played. The expression on her face, then, had been the one he'd seen, hours later, on her sleeping face in a portside coffin, her upper lip like the line children draw to represent a bird in flight.*
[42] Crossing the arcade to stand beside her, high on the deal he'd made, he saw her glance up. Gray eyes rimmed with smudged black paintstick. Eyes of some animal pinned in the headlights of an oncoming vehicle.	*[42] (B n dsch song ngœ chu'n): Crossing the arcade to stand beside her, high on the deal he'd made, he saw her glance up. Gray eyes rimmed with smudged black paintstick. Eyes of some animal pinned in the headlights of an oncoming vehicle.*
[43] Their night together stretching into a morning, into tickets at the hoverport and his first trip across the Bay. The rain kept up, falling along Harajuku, beading on her plastic jacket, the children of Tokyo trooping past the famous boutiques in white loafers and clingwrap capes, until she'd stood with him in the midnight clatter of a pachinko parlor and held his hand like a child.	*[43] (B n dsch song ngœ chu'n): Their night together stretching into a morning, into tickets at the hoverport and his first trip across the Bay. The rain kept up, falling along Harajuku, beading on her plastic jacket, the children of Tokyo trooping past the famous boutiques in white loafers and clingwrap capes, until she'd stood with him in the midnight clatter of a pachinko parlor and held his hand like a child.*
[44] It took a month for the gestalt of drugs and tension he moved through to turn those perpetually startled eyes into wells of reflexive need. He'd watched her personality fragment, calving like an iceberg, splinters drifting away, and finally he'd seen the raw need, the hungry armature of addiction. He'd watched her track the next hit with a concentration that reminded him of the mantises they sold in stalls along Shiga, beside tanks of blue mutant carp and crickets caged in bamboo.	*[44] (B n dsch song ngœ chu'n): It took a month for the gestalt of drugs and tension he moved through to turn those perpetually startled eyes into wells of reflexive need. He'd watched her personality fragment, calving like an iceberg, splinters drifting away, and finally he'd seen the raw need, the hungry armature of addiction. He'd watched her track the next hit with a concentration that reminded him of the mantises they sold in stalls along Shiga, beside tanks of blue mutant carp and crickets caged in bamboo.*

[45] He stared at the black ring of grounds in his empty cup. It was vibrating with the speed he'd taken. The brown laminate of the tabletop was dull with a patina of tiny scratches. With the dex mounting through his spine he saw the countless random impacts required to create a surface like that. The Jarre was decorated in a dated, nameless style from the previous century, an uneasy blend of Japanese traditional and pale Milanese plastics, but everything seemed to wear a subtle film, as though the bad nerves of a million customers had somehow attacked the mirrors and the once glossy plastics, leaving each surface fogged with something that could never be wiped away.	*[45] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): He stared at the black ring of grounds in his empty cup. It was vibrating with the speed he'd taken. The brown laminate of the tabletop was dull with a patina of tiny scratches. With the dex mounting through his spine he saw the countless random impacts required to create a surface like that. The Jarre was decorated in a dated, nameless style from the previous century, an uneasy blend of Japanese traditional and pale Milanese plastics, but everything seemed to wear a subtle film, as though the bad nerves of a million customers had somehow attacked the mirrors and the once glossy plastics, leaving each surface fogged with something that could never be wiped away.*
[46] "Hey. Case, good buddy..."	*[46] "Hey. Case, good buddy..." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[47] He looked up, met gray eyes ringed with paintstick. She was wearing faded French orbital fatigues and new white sneakers.	*[47] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): He looked up, met gray eyes ringed with paintstick. She was wearing faded French orbital fatigues and new white sneakers.*
[48] "I been lookin'~ for you, man." She took a seat opposite him, her elbows on the table. The sleeves of the blue zipsuit had been ripped out at the shoulders; he automatically checked her arms for signs of derms or the needle. "Want a cigarette?"	*[48] "I been lookin'~ for you, man." She took a seat opposite him, her elbows on the table. The sleeves of the blue zipsuit had been ripped out at the shoulders; he automatically checked her arms for signs of derms or the needle. "Want a cigarette?" ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[49] She dug a crumpled pack of Yeheyuan filters from an ankle pocket and offered him one. He took it, let her light it with a red plastic tube. "You sleepin'~ okay, Case? You look tired." Her accent put her south along the Sprawl, toward Atlanta. The skin below her eyes was pale and unhealthy-looking, but the flesh was still smooth and firm. She was twenty. New lines of pain were starting to etch themselves permanently at the corners of her mouth. Her dark hair was drawn back, held by a band of printed silk. The pattern might have represented microcircuits, or a city map.	*[49] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): She dug a crumpled pack of Yeheyuan filters from an ankle pocket and offered him one. He took it, let her light it with a red plastic tube. "You sleepin'~ okay, Case? You look tired." Her accent put her south along the Sprawl, toward Atlanta. The skin below her eyes was pale and unhealthy-looking, but the flesh was still smooth and firm. She was twenty. New lines of pain were starting to etch themselves permanently at the corners of her mouth. Her dark hair was drawn back, held by a band of printed silk. The pattern might have represented microcircuits, or a city map.*

[50] "Not if I remember to take my pills," he said, as a tangible wave of longing hit him, lust and loneliness riding in on the wavelength of amphetamine. He remembered the smell of her skin in the overheated darkness of a coffin near the port, her fingers locked across the small of his back.	*[50] "Not if I remember to take my pills," he said, as a tangible wave of longing hit him, lust and loneliness riding in on the wavelength of amphetamine. He remembered the smell of her skin in the overheated darkness of a coffin near the port, her fingers locked across the small of his back." ¡ (B n dsch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[51] All the meat, he thought, and all it wants.	*[51] (B n dsch song ngœ chu'n): All the meat, he thought, and all it wants.*
[52] "Wage," she said, narrowing her eyes. "He wants to see you with a hole in your face." She lit her own cigarette.	*[52] "Wage," she said, narrowing her eyes. "He wants to see you with a hole in your face." She lit her own cigarette." ¡ (B n dsch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[53] "Who says? Ratz? You been talking to Ratz?"	*[53] "Who says? Ratz? You been talking to Ratz?" ¡ (B n dsch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[54] "No. Mona. Her new squeeze is one of Wage's boys."	*[54] "No. Mona. Her new squeeze is one of Wage's boys." ¡ (B n dsch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[55] "I don't owe him enough. He does me, he's out the money anyway." He shrugged.	*[55] "I don't owe him enough. He does me, he's out the money anyway." He shrugged." ¡ (B n dsch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[56] "Too many people owe him now, Case. Maybe you get to be the example. You seriously better watch it."	*[56] "Too many people owe him now, Case. Maybe you get to be the example. You seriously better watch it." ¡ (B n dsch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[57] "Sure. How about you, Linda? You got anywhere to sleep?"	*[57] "Sure. How about you, Linda? You got anywhere to sleep?" ¡ (B n dsch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[58] "Sleep." She shook her head. "Sure, Case." She shivered, hunched forward over the table. Her face was filmed with sweat.	*[58] "Sleep." She shook her head. "Sure, Case." She shivered, hunched forward over the table. Her face was filmed with sweat." ¡ (B n dsch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*

[59] "Here," he said, and dug in the pocket of his windbreaker, coming up with a crumpled fifty. He smoothed it automatically, under the table, folded it in quarters, and passed it to her.	*[59] "Here," he said, and dug in the pocket of his windbreaker, coming up with a crumpled fifty. He smoothed it automatically, under the table, folded it in quarters, and passed it to her." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[60] "You need that, honey. You better give it to Wage." There was something in the gray eyes now that he couldn't read, something he'd never seen there before.	*[60] "You need that, honey. You better give it to Wage." There was something in the gray eyes now that he couldn't read, something he'd never seen there before." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[61] "I owe Wage a lot more than that. Take it. I got more coming," he lied, as he watched his New Yen vanish into a zippered pocket.	*[61] "I owe Wage a lot more than that. Take it. I got more coming," he lied, as he watched his New Yen vanish into a zippered pocket." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[62] "You get your money, Case, you find Wage quick."	*[62] "You get your money, Case, you find Wage quick." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[63] "I'll see you, Linda," he said, getting up.	*[63] "I'll see you, Linda," he said, getting up." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[64] "Sure." A millimeter of white showed beneath each of her pupils. Sanpaku. "You watch your back, man."	*[64] "Sure." A millimeter of white showed beneath each of her pupils. Sanpaku. "You watch your back, man." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[65] He nodded, anxious to be gone.	*[65] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): He nodded, anxious to be gone.*
[66] He looked back as the plastic door swung shut behind him, saw her eyes reflected in a cage of red neon.	*[66] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): He looked back as the plastic door swung shut behind him, saw her eyes reflected in a cage of red neon.*
[67] Friday night on Ninsei.	*[67] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Friday night on Ninsei.*
[68] He passed yakitori stands and massage parlors, a franchised coffee shop called Beautiful Girl, the electronic thunder of an arcade. He stepped out of the way to let a dark-suited sarariman by, spotting the Mitsubishi-Genentech logo tattooed across the back of the man's right hand.	*[68] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): He passed yakitori stands and massage parlors, a franchised coffee shop called Beautiful Girl, the electronic thunder of an arcade. He stepped out of the way to let a dark-suited sarariman by, spotting the Mitsubishi-Genentech logo tattooed across the back of the man's right hand.*

[69] Was it authentic? If that's for real, he thought, he's in for trouble. If it wasn't, served him right. M-G employees above a certain level were implanted with advanced microprocessors that monitored mutagen levels in the bloodstream. Gear like that would get you rolled in Night City, rolled straight into a black clinic.	*[69] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Was it authentic? If that's for real, he thought, he's in for trouble. If it wasn't, served him right. M-G employees above a certain level were implanted with advanced microprocessors that monitored mutagen levels in the bloodstream. Gear like that would get you rolled in Night City, rolled straight into a black clinic.*
[70] The sarariman had been Japanese, but the Ninsei crowd was a gaijin crowd. Groups of sailors up from the port, tense solitary tourists hunting pleasures no guidebook listed, Sprawl heavies showing off grafts and implants, and a dozen distinct species of hustler, all swarming the street in an intricate dance of desire and commerce.	*[70] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): The sarariman had been Japanese, but the Ninsei crowd was a gaijin crowd. Groups of sailors up from the port, tense solitary tourists hunting pleasures no guidebook listed, Sprawl heavies showing off grafts and implants, and a dozen distinct species of hustler, all swarming the street in an intricate dance of desire and commerce.*
[71] There were countless theories explaining why Chiba City tolerated the Ninsei enclave, but Case tended toward the idea that the Yakuza might be preserving the place as a kind of historical park, a reminder of humble origins. But he also saw a certain sense in the notion that burgeoning technologies require outlaw zones, that Night City wasn't there for its inhabitants, but as a deliberately unsupervised playground for technology itself.	*[71] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): There were countless theories explaining why Chiba City tolerated the Ninsei enclave, but Case tended toward the idea that the Yakuza might be preserving the place as a kind of historical park, a reminder of humble origins. But he also saw a certain sense in the notion that burgeoning technologies require outlaw zones, that Night City wasn't there for its inhabitants, but as a deliberately unsupervised playground for technology itself.*
[72] Was Linda right, he wondered, staring up at the lights? Would Wage have him killed to make an example? It didn't make much sense, but then Wage dealt primarily in proscribed biologicals, and they said you had to be crazy to do that.	*[72] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Was Linda right, he wondered, staring up at the lights? Would Wage have him killed to make an example? It didn't make much sense, but then Wage dealt primarily in proscribed biologicals, and they said you had to be crazy to do that.*
[73] But Linda said Wage wanted him dead. Case's primary insight into the dynamics of street dealing was that neither the buyer nor the seller really needed him. A middleman's business is to make himself a necessary evil. The dubious niche Case had carved for himself in the criminal ecology of Night City had been cut out with lies, scooped out a night at a time with betrayal. Now, sensing that its walls were starting to crumble, he felt the edge of a strange euphoria.	*[73] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): But Linda said Wage wanted him dead. Case's primary insight into the dynamics of street dealing was that neither the buyer nor the seller really needed him. A middleman's business is to make himself a necessary evil. The dubious niche Case had carved for himself in the criminal ecology of Night City had been cut out with lies, scooped out a night at a time with betrayal. Now, sensing that its walls were starting to crumble, he felt the edge of a strange euphoria.*

[74] The week before, he'd delayed transfer of a synthetic glandular extract, retailing it for a wider margin than usual. He knew Wage hadn't liked that. Wage was his primary supplier, nine years in Chiba and one of the few gaijin dealers who'd managed to forge links with the rigidly stratified criminal establishment beyond Night City's borders. Genetic materials and hormones trickled down to Ninsei along an intricate ladder of fronts and blinds. Somehow Wage had managed to trace something back, once, and now he enjoyed steady connections in a dozen cities.	*[74] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): The week before, he'd delayed transfer of a synthetic glandular extract, retailing it for a wider margin than usual. He knew Wage hadn't liked that. Wage was his primary supplier, nine years in Chiba and one of the few gaijin dealers who'd managed to forge links with the rigidly stratified criminal establishment beyond Night City's borders. Genetic materials and hormones trickled down to Ninsei along an intricate ladder of fronts and blinds. Somehow Wage had managed to trace something back, once, and now he enjoyed steady connections in a dozen cities.*
[75] Case found himself staring through a shop window. The place sold small bright objects to the sailors. Watches, flicknives, lighters, pocket VTRs, simstim decks, weighted manriki chains, and shuriken. The shuriken had always fascinated him, steel stars with knife-sharp points. Some were chromed, others black, others treated with a rainbow surface like oil on water. But the chrome stars held his gaze. They were mounted against scarlet ultrasuede with nearly invisible loops of nylon fishline, their centers stamped with dragons or yinyang symbols. They caught the street's neon and twisted it, and it came to Case that these were the stars under which he voyaged, his destiny spelled out in a constellation of cheap chrome.	*[75] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Case found himself staring through a shop window. The place sold small bright objects to the sailors. Watches, flicknives, lighters, pocket VTRs, simstim decks, weighted manriki chains, and shuriken. The shuriken had always fascinated him, steel stars with knife-sharp points. Some were chromed, others black, others treated with a rainbow surface like oil on water. But the chrome stars held his gaze. They were mounted against scarlet ultrasuede with nearly invisible loops of nylon fishline, their centers stamped with dragons or yinyang symbols. They caught the street's neon and twisted it, and it came to Case that these were the stars under which he voyaged, his destiny spelled out in a constellation of cheap chrome.*
[76] "Julie," he said to his stars. "Time to see old Julie. He'll know."	*[76] "Julie," he said to his stars. "Time to see old Julie. He'll know." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[77] Julius Deane was one hundred and thirty-five years old, his metabolism assiduously warped by a weekly fortune in serums and hormones. His primary hedge against aging was a yearly pilgrimage to Tokyo, where genetic surgeons re-set the code of his DNA, a procedure unavailable in Chiba. Then he'd fly to Hongkong and order the year's suits and shirts. Sexless and inhumanly patient, his primary gratification seemed to lie in his devotion to esoteric forms of tailor-worship. Case had never seen him wear the same suit twice, although his wardrobe seemed to consist entirely of meticulous reconstructions of garments of the previous century. He affected prescription lenses, framed in spidery gold, ground from thin slabs of pink synthetic quartz and beveled like the mirrors in a Victorian dollhouse.	*[77] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Julius Deane was one hundred and thirty-five years old, his metabolism assiduously warped by a weekly fortune in serums and hormones. His primary hedge against aging was a yearly pilgrimage to Tokyo, where genetic surgeons re-set the code of his DNA, a procedure unavailable in Chiba. Then he'd fly to Hongkong and order the year's suits and shirts. Sexless and inhumanly patient, his primary gratification seemed to lie in his devotion to esoteric forms of tailor-worship. Case had never seen him wear the same suit twice, although his wardrobe seemed to consist entirely of meticulous reconstructions of garments of the previous century. He affected prescription lenses, framed in spidery gold, ground from thin slabs of pink synthetic quartz and beveled like the mirrors in a Victorian dollhouse.*

[78] His offices were located in a warehouse behind Ninsei, part of which seemed to have been sparsely decorated, years before, with a random collection of European furniture, as though Deane had once intended to use the place as his home. Neo Aztec bookcases gathered dust against one wall of the room where Case waited. A pair of bulbous Disney-styled table lamps perched awkwardly on a low Kandinsky-look coffee table in scarlet-lacquered steel. A Dali clock hung on the wall between the bookcases, its distorted face sagging to the bare concrete floor. Its hands were holograms that altered to match the convolutions of the face as they rotated, but it never told the correct time. The room was stacked with white fiberglass shipping modules that gave off the tang of preserved ginger.	*[78] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): His offices were located in a warehouse behind Ninsei, part of which seemed to have been sparsely decorated, years before, with a random collection of European furniture, as though Deane had once intended to use the place as his home. Neo Aztec bookcases gathered dust against one wall of the room where Case waited. A pair of bulbous Disney-styled table lamps perched awkwardly on a low Kandinsky-look coffee table in scarlet-lacquered steel. A Dali clock hung on the wall between the bookcases, its distorted face sagging to the bare concrete floor. Its hands were holograms that altered to match the convolutions of the face as they rotated, but it never told the correct time. The room was stacked with white fiberglass shipping modules that gave off the tang of preserved ginger.*
[79] "You seem to be clean, old son," said Deane's disembodied voice. "Do come in."	*[79] "You seem to be clean, old son," said Deane's disembodied voice. "Do come in." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[80] Magnetic bolts thudded out of position around the massive imitation-rosewood door to the left of the bookcases. JULIUS DEANE IMPORT EXPORT was lettered across the plastic in peeling self-adhesive capitals. If the furniture scattered in Deane's makeshift foyer suggested the end of the past century, the office itself seemed to belong to its start.	*[80] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Magnetic bolts thudded out of position around the massive imitation-rosewood door to the left of the bookcases. JULIUS DEANE IMPORT EXPORT was lettered across the plastic in peeling self-adhesive capitals. If the furniture scattered in Deane's makeshift foyer suggested the end of the past century, the office itself seemed to belong to its start.*
[81] Deane's seamless pink face regarded Case from a pool of light cast by an ancient brass lamp with a rectangular shade of dark green glass. The importer was securely fenced behind a vast desk of painted steel, flanked on either side by tall, drawered cabinets made of some sort of pale wood. The sort of thing, Case supposed, that had once been used to store written records of some kind. The desktop was littered with cassettes, scrolls of yellowed printout, and various parts of some sort of clockwork typewriter, a machine Deane never seemed to get around to reassembling.	*[81] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Deane's seamless pink face regarded Case from a pool of light cast by an ancient brass lamp with a rectangular shade of dark green glass. The importer was securely fenced behind a vast desk of painted steel, flanked on either side by tall, drawered cabinets made of some sort of pale wood. The sort of thing, Case supposed, that had once been used to store written records of some kind. The desktop was littered with cassettes, scrolls of yellowed printout, and various parts of some sort of clockwork typewriter, a machine Deane never seemed to get around to reassembling.*

[82] "What brings you around, boyo?" Deane asked, offering Case a narrow bonbon wrapped in blue-and-white checked paper. "Try one. Ting Ting Djahe, the very best." Case refused the ginger, took a seat in a yawing wooden swivel chair, and ran a thumb down the faded seam of one black jeans-leg. "Julie, I hear Wage wants to kill me."	*[82] "What brings you around, boyo?" Deane asked, offering Case a narrow bonbon wrapped in blue-and-white checked paper. "Try one. Ting Ting Djahe, the very best." Case refused the ginger, took a seat in a yawing wooden swivel chair, and ran a thumb down the faded seam of one black jeans-leg. "Julie, I hear Wage wants to kill me." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[83] "Ah. Well then. And where did you hear this, if I may?"	*[83] "Ah. Well then. And where did you hear this, if I may?" ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[84] "People."	*[84] "People." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[85] "People," Deane said, around a ginger bonbon. "What sort of people? Friends?"	*[85] "People," Deane said, around a ginger bonbon. "What sort of people? Friends?" ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[86] Case nodded.	*[86] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Case nodded.*
[87] "Not always that easy to know who your friends are, is it?"	*[87] "Not always that easy to know who your friends are, is it?" ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[88] "I do owe him a little money, Deane. He say anything to you?"	*[88] "I do owe him a little money, Deane. He say anything to you?" ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[89] "Haven't been in touch, of late." Then he sighed. "If I _did_ know, of course, I might not be in a position to tell you. Things being what they are, you understand."	*[89] "Haven't been in touch, of late." Then he sighed. "If I _did_ know, of course, I might not be in a position to tell you. Things being what they are, you understand." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[90] "Things?"	*[90] "Things?" ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[91] "He's an important connection, Case."	*[91] "He's an important connection, Case." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*

[92] "Yeah. He want to kill me, Julie?"	*[92] "Yeah. He want to kill me, Julie?" ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[93] "Not that I know of." Deane shrugged. They might have been discussing the price of ginger. "If it proves to be an unfounded rumor, old son, you come back in a week or so and I'll let you in on a little something out of Singapore."	*[93] "Not that I know of." Deane shrugged. They might have been discussing the price of ginger. "If it proves to be an unfounded rumor, old son, you come back in a week or so and I'll let you in on a little something out of Singapore." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[94] "Out of the Nan Hai Hotel, Bencoolen Street?"	*[94] "Out of the Nan Hai Hotel, Bencoolen Street?" ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[95] "Loose lips, old son!" Deane grinned. The steel desk was jammed with a fortune in debugging gear.	*[95] "Loose lips, old son!" Deane grinned. The steel desk was jammed with a fortune in debugging gear." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[96] "Be seeing you, Julie. I'll say hello to Wage."	*[96] "Be seeing you, Julie. I'll say hello to Wage." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[97] Deane's fingers came up to brush the perfect knot in his pale silk tie.	*[97] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Deane's fingers came up to brush the perfect knot in his pale silk tie.*
[98] He was less than a block from Deane's office when it hit, the sudden cellular awareness that someone was on his ass, and very close.	*[98] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): He was less than a block from Deane's office when it hit, the sudden cellular awareness that someone was on his ass, and very close.*

[99] The cultivation of a certain tame paranoia was something Case took for granted. The trick lay in not letting it get out of control. But that could be quite a trick, behind a stack of octagons. He fought the adrenaline surge and composed his narrow features in a mask of bored vacancy, pretending to let the crowd carry him along. When he saw a darkened display window, he managed to pause by it. The place was a surgical boutique, closed for renovations. With his hands in the pockets of his jacket, he stared through the glass at a flat lozenge of vatgrown flesh that lay on a carved pedestal of imitation jade. The color of its skin reminded him of Zone's whores; it was tattooed with a luminous digital display wired to a subcutaneous chip. Why bother with the surgery, he found himself thinking, while sweat coursed down his ribs, when you could just carry the thing around in your pocket?	*[99] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): The cultivation of a certain tame paranoia was something Case took for granted. The trick lay in not letting it get out of control. But that could be quite a trick, behind a stack of octagons. He fought the adrenaline surge and composed his narrow features in a mask of bored vacancy, pretending to let the crowd carry him along. When he saw a darkened display window, he managed to pause by it. The place was a surgical boutique, closed for renovations. With his hands in the pockets of his jacket, he stared through the glass at a flat lozenge of vatgrown flesh that lay on a carved pedestal of imitation jade. The color of its skin reminded him of Zone's whores; it was tattooed with a luminous digital display wired to a subcutaneous chip. Why bother with the surgery, he found himself thinking, while sweat coursed down his ribs, when you could just carry the thing around in your pocket?*
[100] Without moving his head, he raised his eyes and studied the reflection of the passing crowd.	*[100] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Without moving his head, he raised his eyes and studied the reflection of the passing crowd.*
[101] There.	*[101] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): There.*
[102] Behind sailors in short-sleeved khaki. Dark hair, mirrored glasses, dark clothing, slender...	*[102] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Behind sailors in short-sleeved khaki. Dark hair, mirrored glasses, dark clothing, slender...*
[103] And gone.	*[103] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): And gone.*
[104] Then Case was running, bent low, dodging between bodies.	*[104] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Then Case was running, bent low, dodging between bodies.*
[105] "Rent me a gun, Shin?"	*[105] "Rent me a gun, Shin?" ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[106] The boy smiled. "Two hour." They stood together in the smell of fresh raw seafood at the rear of a Shiga sushi stall. "You come back, two hour."	*[106] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): The boy smiled. "Two hour." They stood together in the smell of fresh raw seafood at the rear of a Shiga sushi stall. "You come back, two hour."*
[107] "I need one now, man. Got anything right now?"	*[107] "I need one now, man. Got anything right now?" ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[108] Shin rummaged behind empty two-liter cans that had once been filled with powdered horseradish. He produced a slender package wrapped in gray plastic. "Taser. One hour, twenty New Yen. Thirty deposit."	*[108] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Shin rummaged behind empty two-liter cans that had once been filled with powdered horseradish. He produced a slender package wrapped in gray plastic. "Taser. One hour, twenty New Yen. Thirty deposit."*

[109] "Shit. I don't need that. I need a gun. Like I maybe wanna shoot somebody, understand?"	*[109] "Shit. I don't need that. I need a gun. Like I maybe wanna shoot somebody, understand?" ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[110] The waiter shrugged, replacing the taser behind the horseradish cans. "Two hour."	*[110] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): The waiter shrugged, replacing the taser behind the horseradish cans. "Two hour."*
[111] He went into the shop without bothering to glance at the display of shuriken. He'd never thrown one in his life.	*[111] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): He went into the shop without bothering to glance at the display of shuriken. He'd never thrown one in his life.*
[112] He bought two packs of Yeheyuans with a Mitsubishi Bank chip that gave his name as Charles Derek May. It beat Truman Starr, the best he'd been able to do for a passport.	*[112] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): He bought two packs of Yeheyuans with a Mitsubishi Bank chip that gave his name as Charles Derek May. It beat Truman Starr, the best he'd been able to do for a passport.*
[113] The Japanese woman behind the terminal looked like she had a few years on old Deane, none of them with the benefit of science. He took his slender roll of New Yen out of his pocket and showed it to her. "I want to buy a weapon."	*[113] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): The Japanese woman behind the terminal looked like she had a few years on old Deane, none of them with the benefit of science. He took his slender roll of New Yen out of his pocket and showed it to her. "I want to buy a weapon."*
[114] She gestured in the direction of a case filled with knives.	*[114] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): She gestured in the direction of a case filled with knives.*
[115] "No," he said, "I don't like knives."	*[115] "No," he said, "I don't like knives." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[116] She brought an oblong box from beneath the counter. The lid was yellow cardboard, stamped with a crude image of a coiled cobra with a swollen hood. Inside were eight identical tissue-wrapped cylinders. He watched while mottled brown fingers stripped the paper from one. She held the thing up for him to examine, a dull steel tube with a leather thong at one end and a small bronze pyramid at the other. She gripped the tube with one hand, the pyramid between her other thumb and forefinger, and pulled. Three oiled, telescoping segments of tightly wound coilspring slid out and locked. "Cobra," she said.	*[116] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): She brought an oblong box from beneath the counter. The lid was yellow cardboard, stamped with a crude image of a coiled cobra with a swollen hood. Inside were eight identical tissue-wrapped cylinders. He watched while mottled brown fingers stripped the paper from one. She held the thing up for him to examine, a dull steel tube with a leather thong at one end and a small bronze pyramid at the other. She gripped the tube with one hand, the pyramid between her other thumb and forefinger, and pulled. Three oiled, telescoping segments of tightly wound coilspring slid out and locked. "Cobra," she said.*

[117] Beyond the neon shudder of Ninsei, the sky was that mean shade of gray. The air had gotten worse; it seemed to have teeth tonight, and half the crowd wore filtration masks. Case had spent ten minutes in a urinal, trying to discover a convenient way to conceal his cobra; finally he'd settled for tucking the handle into the waistband of his jeans, with the tube slanting across his stomach. The pyramidal striking tip rode between his ribcage and the lining of his windbreaker. The thing felt like it might clatter to the pavement with his next step, but it made him feel better.	*[117] (B n dsch song ngœ chu'n): Beyond the neon shudder of Ninsei, the sky was that mean shade of gray. The air had gotten worse; it seemed to have teeth tonight, and half the crowd wore filtration masks. Case had spent ten minutes in a urinal, trying to discover a convenient way to conceal his cobra; finally he'd settled for tucking the handle into the waistband of his jeans, with the tube slanting across his stomach. The pyramidal striking tip rode between his ribcage and the lining of his windbreaker. The thing felt like it might clatter to the pavement with his next step, but it made him feel better.*
[118] The Chat wasn't really a dealing bar, but on weeknights it attracted a related clientele. Fridays and Saturdays were different. The regulars were still there, most of them, but they faded behind an influx of sailors and the specialists who preyed on them. As Case pushed through the doors, he looked for Ratz, but the bartender wasn't in sight. Lonny Zone, the bar's resident pimp, was observing with glazed fatherly interest as one of his girls went to work on a young sailor. Zone was addicted to a brand of hypnotic the Japanese called Cloud Dancers. Catching the pimp's eye, Case beckoned him to the bar. Zone came drifting through the crowd in slow motion, his long face slack and placid.	*[118] (B n dsch song ngœ chu'n): The Chat wasn't really a dealing bar, but on weeknights it attracted a related clientele. Fridays and Saturdays were different. The regulars were still there, most of them, but they faded behind an influx of sailors and the specialists who preyed on them. As Case pushed through the doors, he looked for Ratz, but the bartender wasn't in sight. Lonny Zone, the bar's resident pimp, was observing with glazed fatherly interest as one of his girls went to work on a young sailor. Zone was addicted to a brand of hypnotic the Japanese called Cloud Dancers. Catching the pimp's eye, Case beckoned him to the bar. Zone came drifting through the crowd in slow motion, his long face slack and placid.*
[119] "You seen Wage tonight, Lonny?"	*[119] "You seen Wage tonight, Lonny?" ¡ (B n dsch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[120] Zone regarded him with his usual calm. He shook his head.	*[120] (B n dsch song ngœ chu'n): Zone regarded him with his usual calm. He shook his head.*
[121] "You sure, man?"	*[121] "You sure, man?" ¡ (B n dsch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[122] "Maybe in the Namban. Maybe two hours ago."	*[122] "Maybe in the Namban. Maybe two hours ago." ¡ (B n dsch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[123] "Got some joeboys with him? One of 'em thin, dark hair, maybe a black jacket?"	*[123] "Got some joeboys with him? One of 'em thin, dark hair, maybe a black jacket?" ¡ (B n dsch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*

[124] "No," Zone said at last, his smooth forehead creased to indicate the effort it cost him to recall so much pointless detail. "Big boys. Graftees." Zone's eyes showed very little white and less iris; under the drooping lids, his pupils were dilated and enormous. He stared into Case's face for a long time, then lowered his gaze. He saw the bulge of the steel whip. "Cobra," he said, and raised an eyebrow. "You wanna fuck somebody up?"	*[124] "No," Zone said at last, his smooth forehead creased to indicate the effort it cost him to recall so much pointless detail. "Big boys. Graftees." Zone's eyes showed very little white and less iris; under the drooping lids, his pupils were dilated and enormous. He stared into Case's face for a long time, then lowered his gaze. He saw the bulge of the steel whip. "Cobra," he said, and raised an eyebrow. "You wanna fuck somebody up?" ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[125] "See you, Lonny." Case left the bar.	*[125] "See you, Lonny." Case left the bar." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[126] His tail was back. He was sure of it. He felt a stab of elation, the octagons and adrenaline mingling with something else. You're enjoying this, he thought; you're crazy.	*[126] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): His tail was back. He was sure of it. He felt a stab of elation, the octagons and adrenaline mingling with something else. You're enjoying this, he thought; you're crazy.*
[127] Because, in some weird and very approximate way, it was like a run in the matrix. Get just wasted enough, find yourself in some desperate but strangely arbitrary kind of trouble, and it was possible to see Ninsei as a field of data, the way the matrix had once reminded him of proteins linking to distinguish cell specialties. Then you could throw yourself into a highspeed drift and skid, totally engaged but set apart from it all, and all around you the dance of biz, information interacting, data made flesh in the mazes of the black market...	*[127] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Because, in some weird and very approximate way, it was like a run in the matrix. Get just wasted enough, find yourself in some desperate but strangely arbitrary kind of trouble, and it was possible to see Ninsei as a field of data, the way the matrix had once reminded him of proteins linking to distinguish cell specialties. Then you could throw yourself into a highspeed drift and skid, totally engaged but set apart from it all, and all around you the dance of biz, information interacting, data made flesh in the mazes of the black market...*
[128] Go it, Case, he told himself. Suck 'em in. Last thing they'll expect. He was half a block from the games arcade where he'd first met Linda Lee.	*[128] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Go it, Case, he told himself. Suck 'em in. Last thing they'll expect. He was half a block from the games arcade where he'd first met Linda Lee.*

[129] He bolted across Ninsei, scattering a pack of strolling sailors. One of them screamed after him in Spanish. Then he was through the entrance, the sound crashing over him like surf, subsonics throbbing in the pit of his stomach. Someone scored a ten-megaton hit on Tank War Europa, a simulated airburst drowning the arcade in white sound as a lurid hologram fireball mushroomed overhead. He cut to the right and loped up a flight of unpainted chipboard stairs. He'd come here once with Wage, to discuss a deal in proscribed hormonal triggers with a man called Matsuga. He remembered the hallway, its stained matting, the row of identical doors leading to tiny office cubicles. One door was open now. A Japanese girl in a sleeveless black t-shirt glanced up from a white terminal, behind her head a travel poster of Greece, Aegian blue splashed with streamlined ideograms.	*[129] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): He bolted across Ninsei, scattering a pack of strolling sailors. One of them screamed after him in Spanish. Then he was through the entrance, the sound crashing over him like surf, subsonics throbbing in the pit of his stomach. Someone scored a ten-megaton hit on Tank War Europa, a simulated airburst drowning the arcade in white sound as a lurid hologram fireball mushroomed overhead. He cut to the right and loped up a flight of unpainted chipboard stairs. He'd come here once with Wage, to discuss a deal in proscribed hormonal triggers with a man called Matsuga. He remembered the hallway, its stained matting, the row of identical doors leading to tiny office cubicles. One door was open now. A Japanese girl in a sleeveless black t-shirt glanced up from a white terminal, behind her head a travel poster of Greece, Aegian blue splashed with streamlined ideograms.*
[130] "Get your security up here," Case told her.	*[130] "Get your security up here," Case told her." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[131] Then he sprinted down the corridor, out of her sight. The last two doors were closed and, he assumed, locked. He spun and slammed the sole of his nylon running shoe into the bluelacquered composition door at the far end. It popped, cheap hardware failing from the splintered frame. Darkness there, the white curve of a terminal housing. Then he was on the door to its right, both hands around the transparent plastic knob, leaning in with everything he had. Something snapped, and he was inside. This was where he and Wage had met with Matsuga, but whatever front company Matsuga had operated was long gone. No terminal, nothing. Light from the alley behind the arcade, filtering in through sootblown plastic. He made out a snakelike loop of fiberoptics protruding from a wall socket, a pile of discarded food containers, and the bladeless nacelle of an electric fan.	*[131] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Then he sprinted down the corridor, out of her sight. The last two doors were closed and, he assumed, locked. He spun and slammed the sole of his nylon running shoe into the bluelacquered composition door at the far end. It popped, cheap hardware failing from the splintered frame. Darkness there, the white curve of a terminal housing. Then he was on the door to its right, both hands around the transparent plastic knob, leaning in with everything he had. Something snapped, and he was inside. This was where he and Wage had met with Matsuga, but whatever front company Matsuga had operated was long gone. No terminal, nothing. Light from the alley behind the arcade, filtering in through sootblown plastic. He made out a snakelike loop of fiberoptics protruding from a wall socket, a pile of discarded food containers, and the bladeless nacelle of an electric fan.*
[132] The window was a single pane of cheap plastic. He shrugged out of his jacket, bundled it around his right hand, and punched. It split, requiring two more blows to free it from the frame. Over the muted chaos of the games, an alarm began to cycle, triggered either by the broken window or by the girl at the head of the corridor.	*[132] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): The window was a single pane of cheap plastic. He shrugged out of his jacket, bundled it around his right hand, and punched. It split, requiring two more blows to free it from the frame. Over the muted chaos of the games, an alarm began to cycle, triggered either by the broken window or by the girl at the head of the corridor.*

[133] Case turned, pulled his jacket on, and flicked the cobra to full extension.	*[133] (B n dsch song ngœ chu'n): Case turned, pulled his jacket on, and flicked the cobra to full extension.*
[134] With the door closed, he was counting on his tail to assume he'd gone through the one he'd kicked half off its hinges. The cobra's bronze pyramid began to bob gently, the spring-steel shaft amplifying his pulse.	*[134] (B n dsch song ngœ chu'n): With the door closed, he was counting on his tail to assume he'd gone through the one he'd kicked half off its hinges. The cobra's bronze pyramid began to bob gently, the spring-steel shaft amplifying his pulse.*
[135] Nothing happened. There was only the surging of the alarm, the crashing of the games, his heart hammering. When the fear came, it was like some half-forgotten friend. Not the cold, rapid mechanism of the dex-paranoia, but simple animal fear. He'd lived for so long on a constant edge of anxiety that he'd almost forgotten what real fear was.	*[135] (B n dsch song ngœ chu'n): Nothing happened. There was only the surging of the alarm, the crashing of the games, his heart hammering. When the fear came, it was like some half-forgotten friend. Not the cold, rapid mechanism of the dex-paranoia, but simple animal fear. He'd lived for so long on a constant edge of anxiety that he'd almost forgotten what real fear was.*
[136] This cubicle was the sort of place where people died. He might die here. They might have guns...	*[136] (B n dsch song ngœ chu'n): This cubicle was the sort of place where people died. He might die here. They might have guns...*
[137] A crash, from the far end of the corridor. A man's voice, shouting something in Japanese. A scream, shrill terror. Another crash.	*[137] (B n dsch song ngœ chu'n): A crash, from the far end of the corridor. A man's voice, shouting something in Japanese. A scream, shrill terror. Another crash.*
[138] And footsteps, unhurried, coming closer.	*[138] (B n dsch song ngœ chu'n): And footsteps, unhurried, coming closer.*
[139] Passing his closed door. Pausing for the space of three rapid beats of his heart. And returning. One, two, three. A bootheel scraped the matting.	*[139] (B n dsch song ngœ chu'n): Passing his closed door. Pausing for the space of three rapid beats of his heart. And returning. One, two, three. A bootheel scraped the matting.*
[140] The last of his octagon-induced bravado collapsed. He snapped the cobra into its handle and scrambled for the window, blind with fear, his nerves screaming. He was up, out, and falling, all before he was conscious of what he'd done. The impact with pavement drove dull rods of pain through his shins.	*[140] (B n dsch song ngœ chu'n): The last of his octagon-induced bravado collapsed. He snapped the cobra into its handle and scrambled for the window, blind with fear, his nerves screaming. He was up, out, and falling, all before he was conscious of what he'd done. The impact with pavement drove dull rods of pain through his shins.*
[141] A narrow wedge of light from a half-open service hatch framed a heap of discarded fiberoptics and the chassis of a junked console. He'd fallen face forward on a slab of soggy chipboard; he rolled over, into the shadow of the console. The cubicle's window was a square of faint light. The alarm still oscillated, louder here, the rear wall dulling the roar of the games.	*[141] (B n dsch song ngœ chu'n): A narrow wedge of light from a half-open service hatch framed a heap of discarded fiberoptics and the chassis of a junked console. He'd fallen face forward on a slab of soggy chipboard; he rolled over, into the shadow of the console. The cubicle's window was a square of faint light. The alarm still oscillated, louder here, the rear wall dulling the roar of the games.*
[142] A head appeared, framed in the window, backlit by the fluorescents in the corridor, then vanished. It returned, but he still couldn't read the features. Glint of silver across the eyes. "Shit," someone said, a woman, in the accent of the northern Sprawl.	*[142] (B n dsch song ngœ chu'n): A head appeared, framed in the window, backlit by the fluorescents in the corridor, then vanished. It returned, but he still couldn't read the features. Glint of silver across the eyes. "Shit," someone said, a woman, in the accent of the northern Sprawl.*

[143] The head was gone. Case lay under the console for a long count of twenty, then stood up. The steel cobra was still in his hand, and it took him a few seconds to remember what it was. He limped away down the alley, nursing his left ankle.	*[143] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): The head was gone. Case lay under the console for a long count of twenty, then stood up. The steel cobra was still in his hand, and it took him a few seconds to remember what it was. He limped away down the alley, nursing his left ankle.*
[144] Shin's pistol was a fifty-year-old Vietnamese imitation of a South American copy of a Walther PPK, double-action on the first shot, with a very rough pull. It was chambered for .22 long rifle, and Case would've preferred lead azide explosives to the simple Chinese hollowpoints Shin had sold him. Still, it was a handgun and nine rounds of ammunition, and as he made his way down Shiga from the sushi stall he cradled it in his jacket pocket. The grips were bright red plastic molded in a raised dragon motif, something to run your thumb across in the dark. He'd consigned the cobra to a dump canister on Ninsei and dry-swallowed another octagon.	*[144] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Shin's pistol was a fifty-year-old Vietnamese imitation of a South American copy of a Walther PPK, double-action on the first shot, with a very rough pull. It was chambered for .22 long rifle, and Case would've preferred lead azide explosives to the simple Chinese hollowpoints Shin had sold him. Still, it was a handgun and nine rounds of ammunition, and as he made his way down Shiga from the sushi stall he cradled it in his jacket pocket. The grips were bright red plastic molded in a raised dragon motif, something to run your thumb across in the dark. He'd consigned the cobra to a dump canister on Ninsei and dry-swallowed another octagon.*
[145] The pill lit his circuits and he rode the rush down Shiga to Ninsei, then over to Baiitsu. His tail, he'd decided, was gone, and that was fine. He had calls to make, biz to transact, and it wouldn't wait. A block down Baiitsu, toward the port, stood a featureless ten-story office building in ugly yellow brick. Its windows were dark now, but a faint glow from the roof was visible if you craned your neck. An unlit neon sign near the main entrance offered CHEAP HOTEL under a cluster of ideograms. If the place had another name, Case didn't know it; it was always referred to as Cheap Hotel. You reached it through an alley off Baiitsu, where an elevator waited at the foot of a transparent shaft. The elevator, like Cheap Hotel, was an afterthought, lashed to the building with bamboo and epoxy. Case climbed into the plastic cage and used his key, an unmarked length of rigid magnetic tape.	*[145] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): The pill lit his circuits and he rode the rush down Shiga to Ninsei, then over to Baiitsu. His tail, he'd decided, was gone, and that was fine. He had calls to make, biz to transact, and it wouldn't wait. A block down Baiitsu, toward the port, stood a featureless ten-story office building in ugly yellow brick. Its windows were dark now, but a faint glow from the roof was visible if you craned your neck. An unlit neon sign near the main entrance offered CHEAP HOTEL under a cluster of ideograms. If the place had another name, Case didn't know it; it was always referred to as Cheap Hotel. You reached it through an alley off Baiitsu, where an elevator waited at the foot of a transparent shaft. The elevator, like Cheap Hotel, was an afterthought, lashed to the building with bamboo and epoxy. Case climbed into the plastic cage and used his key, an unmarked length of rigid magnetic tape.*
[146] Case had rented a coffin here, on a weekly basis, since he'd arrived in Chiba, but he'd never slept in Cheap Hotel. He slept in cheaper places.	*[146] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Case had rented a coffin here, on a weekly basis, since he'd arrived in Chiba, but he'd never slept in Cheap Hotel. He slept in cheaper places.*

[147] The elevator smelled of perfume and cigarettes; the sides of the cage was scratched and thumb-smudged. As it passed the fifth floor, he saw the lights of Ninsei. He drummed his fingers against the pistolgrip as the cage slowed with a gradual hiss. As always, it came to a full stop with a violent jolt, but he was ready for it. He stepped out into the courtyard that served the place as some combination of lobby and lawn.	*[147] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): The elevator smelled of perfume and cigarettes; the sides of the cage was scratched and thumb-smudged. As it passed the fifth floor, he saw the lights of Ninsei. He drummed his fingers against the pistolgrip as the cage slowed with a gradual hiss. As always, it came to a full stop with a violent jolt, but he was ready for it. He stepped out into the courtyard that served the place as some combination of lobby and lawn.*
[148] Centered in the square carpet of green plastic turf, a Japanese teenager sat behind a C-shaped console, reading a textbook. The white fiberglass coffins were racked in a framework of industrial scaffolding. Six tiers of coffins, ten coffins on a side. Case nodded in the boy's direction and limped across the plastic grass to the nearest ladder. The compound was roofed with cheap laminated matting that rattled in a strong wind and leaked when it rained, but the coffins were reasonably difficult to open without a key.	*[148] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Centered in the square carpet of green plastic turf, a Japanese teenager sat behind a C-shaped console, reading a textbook. The white fiberglass coffins were racked in a framework of industrial scaffolding. Six tiers of coffins, ten coffins on a side. Case nodded in the boy's direction and limped across the plastic grass to the nearest ladder. The compound was roofed with cheap laminated matting that rattled in a strong wind and leaked when it rained, but the coffins were reasonably difficult to open without a key.*
[149] The expansion-grate catwalk vibrated with his weight as he edged his way along the third tier to Number 92. The coffins were three meters long, the oval hatches a meter wide and just under a meter and a half tall. He fed his key into the slot and waited for verification from the house computer. Magnetic bolts thudded reassuringly and the hatch rose vertically with a creak of springs. Fluorescents flickered on as he crawled in, pulling the hatch shut behind him and slapping the panel that activated the manual latch.	*[149] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): The expansion-grate catwalk vibrated with his weight as he edged his way along the third tier to Number 92. The coffins were three meters long, the oval hatches a meter wide and just under a meter and a half tall. He fed his key into the slot and waited for verification from the house computer. Magnetic bolts thudded reassuringly and the hatch rose vertically with a creak of springs. Fluorescents flickered on as he crawled in, pulling the hatch shut behind him and slapping the panel that activated the manual latch.*
[150] There was nothing in Number 92 but a standard Hitachi pocket computer and a small white styrofoam cooler chest. The cooler contained the remains of three ten-kilo slabs of dry ice, carefully wrapped in paper to delay evaporation, and a spun aluminum lab flask. Crouching on the brown temperfoam slab that was both floor and bed, Case took Shin's .22 from his pocket and put it on top of the cooler. Then he took off his jacket. The coffin's terminal was molded into one concave wall, opposite a panel listing house rules in seven languages. Case took the pink handset from its cradle and punched a Hongkong number from memory. He let it ring five times, then hung up. His buyer for the three megabytes of hot RAM in the Hitachi wasn't taking calls.	*[150] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): There was nothing in Number 92 but a standard Hitachi pocket computer and a small white styrofoam cooler chest. The cooler contained the remains of three ten-kilo slabs of dry ice, carefully wrapped in paper to delay evaporation, and a spun aluminum lab flask. Crouching on the brown temperfoam slab that was both floor and bed, Case took Shin's .22 from his pocket and put it on top of the cooler. Then he took off his jacket. The coffin's terminal was molded into one concave wall, opposite a panel listing house rules in seven languages. Case took the pink handset from its cradle and punched a Hongkong number from memory. He let it ring five times, then hung up. His buyer for the three megabytes of hot RAM in the Hitachi wasn't taking calls.*
[151] He punched a Tokyo number in Shinjuku.	*[151] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): He punched a Tokyo number in Shinjuku.*

[152] A woman answered, something in Japanese.	*[152] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): A woman answered, something in Japanese.*
[153] "Snake Man there?"	*[153] "Snake Man there?" ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[154] "Very good to hear from you," said Snake Man, coming in on an extension. "I've been expecting your call."	*[154] "Very good to hear from you," said Snake Man, coming in on an extension. "I've been expecting your call." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[155] "I got the music you wanted." Glancing at the cooler.	*[155] "I got the music you wanted." Glancing at the cooler." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[156] "I'm very glad to hear that. We have a cash flow problem. Can you front?"	*[156] "I'm very glad to hear that. We have a cash flow problem. Can you front?" ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[157] "Oh, man, I really need the money bad..."	*[157] "Oh, man, I really need the money bad..." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[158] Snake Man hung up.	*[158] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Snake Man hung up.*
[159] "You shit," Case said to the humming receiver. He stared at the cheap little pistol.	*[159] "You shit," Case said to the humming receiver. He stared at the cheap little pistol." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[160] "Iffy," he said, "it's all looking very iffy tonight."	*[160] "Iffy," he said, "it's all looking very iffy tonight." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[161] Case walked into the Chat an hour before dawn, both hands in the pockets of his jacket: one held the rented pistol, the other the aluminum flask.	*[161] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Case walked into the Chat an hour before dawn, both hands in the pockets of his jacket: one held the rented pistol, the other the aluminum flask.*
[162] Ratz was at a rear table, drinking Apollonaris water from a beer pitcher, his hundred and twenty kilos of doughy flesh tilted against the wall on a creaking chair. A Brazilian kid called Kurt was on the bar, tending a thin crowd of mostly silent drunks. Ratz's plastic arm buzzed as he raised the pitcher and drank. His shaven head was filmed with sweat. "You look bad, friend artiste," he said, flashing the wet ruin of his teeth.	*[162] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Ratz was at a rear table, drinking Apollonaris water from a beer pitcher, his hundred and twenty kilos of doughy flesh tilted against the wall on a creaking chair. A Brazilian kid called Kurt was on the bar, tending a thin crowd of mostly silent drunks. Ratz's plastic arm buzzed as he raised the pitcher and drank. His shaven head was filmed with sweat. "You look bad, friend artiste," he said, flashing the wet ruin of his teeth.*

[163] "I'm doing just fine," said Case, and grinned like a skull. "Super fine." He sagged into the chair opposite Ratz, hands still in his pockets.	*[163] "I'm doing just fine," said Case, and grinned like a skull. "Super fine." He sagged into the chair opposite Ratz, hands still in his pockets." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[164] "And you wander back and forth in this portable bombshelter built of booze and ups, sure. Proof against the grosser emotions, yes?"	*[164] "And you wander back and forth in this portable bombshelter built of booze and ups, sure. Proof against the grosser emotions, yes?" ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[165] "Why don't you get off my case, Ratz? You seen Wage?"	*[165] "Why don't you get off my case, Ratz? You seen Wage?" ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[166] "Proof against fear and being alone," the bartender continued. "Listen to the fear. Maybe it's your friend."	*[166] "Proof against fear and being alone," the bartender continued. "Listen to the fear. Maybe it's your friend." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[167] "You hear anything about a fight in the arcade tonight, Ratz? Somebody hurt?"	*[167] "You hear anything about a fight in the arcade tonight, Ratz? Somebody hurt?" ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[168] "Crazy cut a security man." He shrugged. "A girl, they say."	*[168] "Crazy cut a security man." He shrugged. "A girl, they say." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[169] "I gotta talk to Wage. Ratz, I..."	*[169] "I gotta talk to Wage. Ratz, I..." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[170] "Ah." Ratz's mouth narrowed, compressed into a single line. He was looking past Case, toward the entrance. "I think you are about to."	*[170] "Ah." Ratz's mouth narrowed, compressed into a single line. He was looking past Case, toward the entrance. "I think you are about to." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[171] Case had a sudden flash of the shuriken in their window. The speed sang in his head. The pistol in his hand was slippery with sweat.	*[171] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Case had a sudden flash of the shuriken in their window. The speed sang in his head. The pistol in his hand was slippery with sweat.*

[172] "Herr Wage," Ratz said, slowly extending his pink manipulator as if he expected it to be shaken. "How great a pleasure. Too seldom do you honor us."	*[172] "Herr Wage," Ratz said, slowly extending his pink manipulator as if he expected it to be shaken. "How great a pleasure. Too seldom do you honor us." ¡ (B n dsch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[173] Case turned his head and looked up into Wage's face. It was a tanned and forgettable mask. The eyes were vatgrown sea-green Nikon transplants. Wage wore a suit of gunmetal silk and a simple bracelet of platinum on either wrist. He was flanked by his joeboys, nearly identical young men, their arms and shoulders bulging with grafted muscle.	*[173] (B n dsch song ngœ chu'n): Case turned his head and looked up into Wage's face. It was a tanned and forgettable mask. The eyes were vatgrown sea-green Nikon transplants. Wage wore a suit of gunmetal silk and a simple bracelet of platinum on either wrist. He was flanked by his joeboys, nearly identical young men, their arms and shoulders bulging with grafted muscle.*
[174] "How you doing, Case?"	*[174] "How you doing, Case?" ¡ (B n dsch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[175] "Gentlemen," said Ratz, picking up the table's heaped ashtray in his pink plastic claw, "I want no trouble here." The ashtray was made of thick, shatterproof plastic, and advertised Tsingtao beer. Ratz crushed it smoothly, butts and shards of green plastic cascading onto the tabletop. "You understand?"	*[175] "Gentlemen," said Ratz, picking up the table's heaped ashtray in his pink plastic claw, "I want no trouble here." The ashtray was made of thick, shatterproof plastic, and advertised Tsingtao beer. Ratz crushed it smoothly, butts and shards of green plastic cascading onto the tabletop. "You understand?" ¡ (B n dsch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[176] "Hey, sweetheart," said one of the joeboys, "you wanna try that thing on me?"	*[176] "Hey, sweetheart," said one of the joeboys, "you wanna try that thing on me?" ¡ (B n dsch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[177] "Don't bother aiming for the legs, Kurt," Ratz said, his tone conversational. Case glanced across the room and saw the Brazilian standing on the bar, aiming a Smith & Wesson riot gun at the trio. The thing's barrel, made of paper-thin alloy wrapped with a kilometer of glass filament, was wide enough to swallow a fist. The skeletal magazine revealed five fat orange cartridges, subsonic sandbag jellies.	*[177] "Don't bother aiming for the legs, Kurt," Ratz said, his tone conversational. Case glanced across the room and saw the Brazilian standing on the bar, aiming a Smith & Wesson riot gun at the trio. The thing's barrel, made of paper-thin alloy wrapped with a kilometer of glass filament, was wide enough to swallow a fist. The skeletal magazine revealed five fat orange cartridges, subsonic sandbag jellies." ¡ (B n dsch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[178] "Technically nonlethal," said Ratz.	*[178] "Technically nonlethal," said Ratz." ¡ (B n dsch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*

[179] "Hey, Ratz," Case said, "I owe you one."	*[179] "Hey, Ratz," Case said, "I owe you one." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[180] The bartender shrugged. "Nothing, you owe me. These," and he glowered at Wage and the joeboys, "should know better. You don't take anybody off in the Chatsubo."	*[180] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): The bartender shrugged. "Nothing, you owe me. These," and he glowered at Wage and the joeboys, "should know better. You don't take anybody off in the Chatsubo."*
[181] Wage coughed. "So who's talking about taking anybody off. We just wanna talk business. Case and me, we work together."	*[181] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Wage coughed. "So who's talking about taking anybody off. We just wanna talk business. Case and me, we work together."*
[182] Case pulled the .22 out of his pocket and levelled it at Wage's crotch. "I hear you wanna do me." Ratz's pink claw closed around the pistol and Case let his hand go limp.	*[182] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Case pulled the .22 out of his pocket and levelled it at Wage's crotch. "I hear you wanna do me." Ratz's pink claw closed around the pistol and Case let his hand go limp.*
[183] "Look, Case, you tell me what the fuck is going on with you, you wig or something? What's this shit I'm trying to kill you?" Wage turned to the boy on his left. "You two go back to the Namban. Wait for me."	*[183] "Look, Case, you tell me what the fuck is going on with you, you wig or something? What's this shit I'm trying to kill you?" Wage turned to the boy on his left. "You two go back to the Namban. Wait for me." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[184] Case watched as they crossed the bar, which was now entirely deserted except for Kurt and a drunken sailor in khakis, who was curled at the foot of a barstool. The barrel of the Smith & Wesson tracked the two to the door, then swung back to cover Wage. The magazine of Case's pistol clattered on the table. Ratz held the gun in his claw and pumped the round out of the chamber.	*[184] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Case watched as they crossed the bar, which was now entirely deserted except for Kurt and a drunken sailor in khakis, who was curled at the foot of a barstool. The barrel of the Smith & Wesson tracked the two to the door, then swung back to cover Wage. The magazine of Case's pistol clattered on the table. Ratz held the gun in his claw and pumped the round out of the chamber.*
[185] "Who told you I was going to hit you, Case?" Wage asked.	*[185] "Who told you I was going to hit you, Case?" Wage asked." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[186] Linda.	*[186] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Linda.*
[187] "Who told you, man? Somebody trying to set you up?"	*[187] "Who told you, man? Somebody trying to set you up?" ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[188] The sailor moaned and vomited explosively.	*[188] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): The sailor moaned and vomited explosively.*

[189] "Get him out of here," Ratz called to Kurt, who was sitting on the edge of the bar now, the Smith & Wesson across his lap, lighting a cigarette.	*[189] "Get him out of here," Ratz called to Kurt, who was sitting on the edge of the bar now, the Smith & Wesson across his lap, lighting a cigarette." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[190] Case felt the weight of the night come down on him like a bag of wet sand settling behind his eyes. He took the flask out of his pocket and handed it to Wage. "All I got. Pituitaries. Get you five hundred if you move it fast. Had the rest of my roll in some RAM, but that's gone by now."	*[190] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): Case felt the weight of the night come down on him like a bag of wet sand settling behind his eyes. He took the flask out of his pocket and handed it to Wage. "All I got. Pituitaries. Get you five hundred if you move it fast. Had the rest of my roll in some RAM, but that's gone by now."*
[191] "You okay, Case?" The flask had already vanished behind a gunmetal lapel. "I mean, fine, this'll square us, but you look bad. Like hammered shit. You better go somewhere and sleep."	*[191] "You okay, Case?" The flask had already vanished behind a gunmetal lapel. "I mean, fine, this'll square us, but you look bad. Like hammered shit. You better go somewhere and sleep." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[192] "Yeah." He stood up and felt the Chat sway around him. "Well, I had this fifty, but I gave it to somebody." He giggled. He picked up the .22's magazine and the one loose cartridge and dropped them into one pocket, then put the pistol in the other. "I gotta see Shin, get my deposit back."	*[192] "Yeah." He stood up and felt the Chat sway around him. "Well, I had this fifty, but I gave it to somebody." He giggled. He picked up the .22's magazine and the one loose cartridge and dropped them into one pocket, then put the pistol in the other. "I gotta see Shin, get my deposit back." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[193] "Go home," said Ratz, shifting on the creaking chair with something like embarrassment. "Artiste. Go home."	*[193] "Go home," said Ratz, shifting on the creaking chair with something like embarrassment. "Artiste. Go home." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[194] He felt them watching as he crossed the room and shouldered his way past the plastic doors.	*[194] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): He felt them watching as he crossed the room and shouldered his way past the plastic doors.*

[195] "Bitch," he said to the rose tint over Shiga. Down on Ninsei the holograms were vanishing like ghosts, and most of the neon was already cold and dead. He sipped thick black coffee from a street vendor's foam thimble and watched the sun come up. "You fly away, honey. Towns like this are for people who like the way down." But that wasn't it, really, and he was finding it increasingly hard to maintain the sense of betrayal. She just wanted a ticket home, and the RAM in his Hitachi would buy it for her, if she could find the right fence. And that business with the fifty; she'd almost turned it down, knowing she was about to rip him for the rest of what he had.	*[195] "Bitch," he said to the rose tint over Shiga. Down on Ninsei the holograms were vanishing like ghosts, and most of the neon was already cold and dead. He sipped thick black coffee from a street vendor's foam thimble and watched the sun come up. "You fly away, honey. Towns like this are for people who like the way down." But that wasn't it, really, and he was finding it increasingly hard to maintain the sense of betrayal. She just wanted a ticket home, and the RAM in his Hitachi would buy it for her, if she could find the right fence. And that business with the fifty; she'd almost turned it down, knowing she was about to rip him for the rest of what he had." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[196] When he climbed out of the elevator, the same boy was on the desk. Different textbook. "Good buddy," Case called across the plastic turf, "you don't need to tell me. I know already. Pretty lady came to visit, said she had my key. Nice little tip for you, say fifty New ones?" The boy put down his book. "Woman," Case said, and drew a line across his forehead with his thumb. "Silk." He smiled broadly. The boy smiled back, nodded. "Thanks, asshole," Case said.	*[196] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): When he climbed out of the elevator, the same boy was on the desk. Different textbook. "Good buddy," Case called across the plastic turf, "you don't need to tell me. I know already. Pretty lady came to visit, said she had my key. Nice little tip for you, say fifty New ones?" The boy put down his book. "Woman," Case said, and drew a line across his forehead with his thumb. "Silk." He smiled broadly. The boy smiled back, nodded. "Thanks, asshole," Case said.*
[197] On the catwalk, he had trouble with the lock. She'd messed it up somehow when she'd fiddled it, he thought. Beginner. He knew where to rent a blackbox that would open anything in Cheap Hotel. Fluorescents came on as he crawled in.	*[197] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): On the catwalk, he had trouble with the lock. She'd messed it up somehow when she'd fiddled it, he thought. Beginner. He knew where to rent a blackbox that would open anything in Cheap Hotel. Fluorescents came on as he crawled in.*
[198] "Close the hatch real slow, friend. You still got that Saturday night special you rented from the waiter?"	*[198] "Close the hatch real slow, friend. You still got that Saturday night special you rented from the waiter?" ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[199] She sat with her back to the wall, at the far end of the coffin. She had her knees up, resting her wrists on them; the pepperbox muzzle of a flechette pistol emerged from her hands.	*[199] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): She sat with her back to the wall, at the far end of the coffin. She had her knees up, resting her wrists on them; the pepperbox muzzle of a flechette pistol emerged from her hands.*
[200] "That you in the arcade?" He pulled the hatch down. "Where's Linda?"	*[200] "That you in the arcade?" He pulled the hatch down. "Where's Linda?" ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[201] "Hit that latch switch."	*[201] "Hit that latch switch." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph… Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*

[202] He did.	*[202] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): He did.*
[203] "That your girl? Linda?"	*[203] "That your girl? Linda?" ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[204] He nodded.	*[204] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): He nodded.*
[205] "She's gone. Took your Hitachi. Real nervous kid. What about the gun, man?" She wore mirrored glasses. Her clothes were black, the heels of black boots deep in the temperfoam.	*[205] "She's gone. Took your Hitachi. Real nervous kid. What about the gun, man?" She wore mirrored glasses. Her clothes were black, the heels of black boots deep in the temperfoam." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[206] "I took it back to Shin, got my deposit. Sold his bullets back to him for half what I paid. You want the money?"	*[206] "I took it back to Shin, got my deposit. Sold his bullets back to him for half what I paid. You want the money?" ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[207] "No."	*[207] "No." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[208] "Want some dry ice? All I got, right now."	*[208] "Want some dry ice? All I got, right now." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[209] "What got into you tonight? Why'd you pull that scene at the arcade? I had to mess up this rentacop came after me with nunchucks."	*[209] "What got into you tonight? Why'd you pull that scene at the arcade? I had to mess up this rentacop came after me with nunchucks." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[210] "Linda said you were gonna kill me."	*[210] "Linda said you were gonna kill me." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[211] "Linda said? I never saw her before I came up here."	*[211] "Linda said? I never saw her before I came up here." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[212] "You aren't with Wage?"	*[212] "You aren't with Wage?" ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*

[213] She shook her head. He realized that the glasses were surgically inset, sealing her sockets. The silver lenses seemed to grow from smooth pale skin above her cheekbones, framed by dark hair cut in a rough shag. The fingers curled around the fletcher were slender, white, tipped with polished burgundy. The nails looked artificial. "I think you screwed up, Case. I showed up and you just fit me right into your reality picture."	*[213] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): She shook her head. He realized that the glasses were surgically inset, sealing her sockets. The silver lenses seemed to grow from smooth pale skin above her cheekbones, framed by dark hair cut in a rough shag. The fingers curled around the fletcher were slender, white, tipped with polished burgundy. The nails looked artificial. "I think you screwed up, Case. I showed up and you just fit me right into your reality picture."*
[214] "So what do you want, lady?" He sagged back against the hatch.	*[214] "So what do you want, lady?" He sagged back against the hatch." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[215] "You. One live body, brains still somewhat intact. Molly, Case. My name's Molly. I'm collecting you for the man I work for. Just wants to talk; is all. Nobody wants to hurt you."	*[215] "You. One live body, brains still somewhat intact. Molly, Case. My name's Molly. I'm collecting you for the man I work for. Just wants to talk; is all. Nobody wants to hurt you." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[216] "That's good."	*[216] "That's good." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[217] "'Cept I do hurt people sometimes, Case. I guess it's just the way I'm wired." She wore tight black gloveleather jeans and a bulky black jacket cut from some matte fabric that seemed to absorb light. "If I put this dartgun away, will you be easy, Case? You look like you like to take stupid chances."	*[217] "'Cept I do hurt people sometimes, Case. I guess it's just the way I'm wired." She wore tight black gloveleather jeans and a bulky black jacket cut from some matte fabric that seemed to absorb light. "If I put this dartgun away, will you be easy, Case? You look like you like to take stupid chances." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[218] "Hey, I'm very easy. I'm a pushover, no problem."	*[218] "Hey, I'm very easy. I'm a pushover, no problem." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[219] "That's fine, man." The fletcher vanished into the black jacket. "Because you try to fuck around with me, you'll be taking one of the stupidest chances of your whole life."	*[219] "That's fine, man." The fletcher vanished into the black jacket. "Because you try to fuck around with me, you'll be taking one of the stupidest chances of your whole life." ¡ (B n dšch ngœ c nh: o n h i tho i nguy n t c ph n nh nhšp i u ng ph... Chiba City ng p tr n ti ng l ng c ng ngh v b u kh ng kh c ng th•ng).*
[220] She held out her hands, palms up, the white fingers slightly spread, and with a barely audible click, ten double-edged, fourcentimeter scalpel blades slid from their housings beneath the burgundy nails.	*[220] (B n dšch song ngœ chu'n): She held out her hands, palms up, the white fingers slightly spread, and with a barely audible click, ten double-edged, fourcentimeter scalpel blades slid from their housings beneath the burgundy nails.*

[221] She smiled. The blades slowly withdrew.	*[221] (B n dšch song ngœ chu’n): She smiled. The blades slowly withdrew.*